

Monthly JBV / Research Policy Digest

Generated: 2026-08-15 22:07 Coverage: 2026-09 to 2026-11 | Journal of Business Venturing (4); Research Policy (11) **Total papers:** 15 (15 with abstract, 15 with PDF)

Journal breakdown: - Journal of Business Venturing: 4 - Research Policy: 11

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Journal of Business Venturing

Volume 41, Issue 6 | Published 2026-11

1. Baby on board! First-time parenthood as a catalyst for venture professionalization

Authors: Amelie Pahl, Blake Mathias, Hana Milanov

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106629](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106629) Published: 2026-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Behavior, Organizational Behavior, Venture Professionalization
- **Theories:** Role Theory, Work-Family Enrichment, Work-Family Conflict

Abstract:

Most entrepreneurs become parents while actively growing their ventures. While prior entrepreneurship research has examined how parenting responsibilities influence entrepreneurial entry and outcomes, less is known about how founders already leading ventures experience the transition into parenthood and how this life-stage change affects organizing. To examine this, we draw on interviews with 32 qualitative with growth-oriented parent-founders and their co-founders and spouses in Germany. Building on role theory, we find that parenthood, as a major life-stage transition, can trigger venture professionalization. Specifically, we identify two distinct professionalization pathways shaped by how founders interpret the relationship between their parental and entrepreneurial roles. In a conflict-driven pathway, founders interpret parenthood as incompatible with entrepreneurship and engage in defensive micro-role transitions such as task delegation and structural buffering to protect their entrepreneurial role while retaining centralized authority in the venture. In contrast, an enrichment-driven pathway emerges when founders view parenthood as complementary to entrepreneurship, prompting developmental micro-role transitions that redistribute authority, empower others, and embed family-friendly values of flexibility and care into organizational practices. By theorizing how a

macro life-stage transition triggers divergent micro-role transitions with implications for venture development, this study advances role theory in entrepreneurship and contributes to entrepreneurship research on venture professionalization.

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2. Leap or wait? Venture capital timing through the lens of technology validation

Authors: Shahrokh Firouzi, Sandro Claudio Lera

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106631](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106631) **Published:** 2026-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Venture Capital, Entrepreneurial Finance, Technology Management
- **Theories:** Technology Validation Trajectory, Sociocognitive Perspective, Information Asymmetry

Abstract:

Uncertainty in venture capital investment is shaped not only by startup characteristics, but also by financing conditions, sociocognitive cues, and investor-level factors. This article develops a framework in which venture capital timing is understood relative to an underlying technology's validation trajectory, that is, the broader process through which the technology becomes more visible, interpretable, and financeable for investors. This perspective provides a common frame of reference for comparing investments across otherwise very different technologies and suggests that earlier positions along the trajectory may offer access to more uncertain but higher- upside opportunities, that VC firms differ systematically in their typical timing, and that this heterogeneity is shaped by both funding conditions and investor prominence. Empirically, we operationalize this framework by using Google Trends as a broad observable marker of public visibility and, with it, a tractable proxy for where a technology stands along its validation trajectory. We then position more than 64,000 U.S. venture capital investments relative to technology-specific visibility trajectories spanning more than 100 emerging technology domains. We show that startups funded earlier along these trajectories are associated with significantly higher success rates, that VC firms differ meaningfully in their typical investment timing, that worsening funding conditions shift investment toward technologies further along their validation trajectories, and that greater reputational prominence is associated with earlier investment timing. These findings investment timing relative to domain validation as a distinct dimension of entrepreneurial finance and provide a scalable framework for analyzing how capital is allocated across emerging technologies.

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3. The yin and yang: Utility and reform perspectives on social impact in social entrepreneurship research

Authors: Georgios Polychronopoulos, Martin Lukeš, Siddharth Vedula, Sophie Bacq

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106630](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106630) **Published:** 2026-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Social Entrepreneurship, Social Impact
- **Theories:** Functionalism, Interpretivism, Agency Theory

Abstract:

Positive social impact is the aspirational *raison d'être* of social entrepreneurship, driving its mission and actions, yet it remains theoretically ambiguous across the academic literature. This systematic integrative review identifies two distinct perspectives through which social impact is theorized in social entrepreneurship research: social impact as utility and social impact as reform. The former adheres to a functionalist paradigm rooted in economics and conceptualizes social impact as changes in social utility through the mobilization of capital, whereas the latter aligns with an interpretivist paradigm rooted in sociology and conceptualizes social impact as the re form of social systems through the mobilization of agency. By examining the outcomes

and mechanisms of social impact associated with each perspective, we develop a multilevel organizing framework that clarifies and synthesizes the extant literature, while laying the groundwork for a programmatic theory of social impact.

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Volume 41, Issue 5 | Published 2026-09

1. Migrating to a golden opportunity: The gold rush and the roots of persistence of interregional differences in entrepreneurship

Authors: Michael Stuetzer, Michael Wyrwich, Abel Brodeur, Martin Obschonka, David B. Audretsch, Peter J. Rentfrow, Jeff Potter, Samuel D. Gosling

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106626](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106626) **Published:** 2026-09

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Regional Entrepreneurship, Economic History, Entrepreneurial Geography
- **Theories:** Imprinting Theory, Path Dependency, Selective Migration

Abstract:

Regional differences in entrepreneurship are persistent over time. However, little is known about the historical roots of this persistence and the mechanisms linking these roots to entrepreneurial activity over time. In this paper, we aim to explore the persistence of regional entrepreneurship in the U.S., which we trace back to the gold rushes of the 19th century. In this exploratory paper, our focus is mainly on the migration of entrepreneurially minded individuals as a mechanism through which the gold rush influenced entrepreneurship over time. We find empirical evidence of selective migration from entrepreneurial regions and from individuals employed in entrepreneurial occupations to gold rush counties over a period of 100 years. Moreover, migration to the gold rush counties made people more entrepreneurial compared to both migrants moving elsewhere and non-migrants. We also find some evidence that states strongly affected by the gold rush have in contemporary times more entrepreneurship-friendly laws and regulations as well as a more entrepreneurial culture. Lastly, we show that gold rush regions, compared to neighboring regions without a gold rush, have persistently higher entrepreneurship rates from the earliest available data in 1910 to the present. Taken together, our analyses indicate that the gold rush and subsequent migration patterns had a long-term positive effect on entrepreneurship.

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Research Policy

Volume 55, Issue 9 | Published 2026-11

1. Are circular innovations disruptive? An analysis of the role of inventor networks in the European semiconductor industry

Authors: Priyanshu Protim Pathak, Silvia Massini, Lucia Piscitello

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105574](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105574) **Published:** 2026-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Sustainability, Social Network Analysis
- **Theories:** Disruptive Innovation, Social Network Theory, Structural Hole Theory

Abstract:

The expansion of advanced technologies is intensifying demand for energy, materials, and efficiency of production systems, with semiconductors exemplifying the tension between rapid technological progress and resource sustainability, and the development of circular innovations. Yet it remains unclear whether circular innovations in this sector tend to be genuinely disruptive. This study examines the disruptiveness of circular (vs. non-circular) innovations and analyses the role of inventor network structures. The empirical analysis relies on the patents of 299 European Semiconductor Equipment Manufacturing (SEM) companies retrieved from the ORBIS IP database for the period 2013–2022. First, we operationalize disruptiveness by adopting a citation-based measure to reveal whether subsequent inventions build upon or bypass a focal patent's prior art. Then, co-inventor networks are constructed, and inventor centrality and cohesion measures are aggregated to the patent level to link inventor network structure to disruptive outcomes over time. Our findings show that circular patents exhibit, on average, higher disruptiveness than non-circular patents, and that inventor network structures characterized by more peripheral and high local cohesive configurations align with disruptive circular outcomes. The effect of the network antecedents differs systematically between circular and non-circular innovations, indicating distinct pathways to disruption. The study contributes to the innovation literature by integrating a structural disruptiveness measure with inventor network analytics, offering one of the first patent-level comparisons of circular versus non-circular disruptiveness in the semiconductor industry, and by deriving implications for organizing collaboration portfolios and policy instruments that foster circular transitions.

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2. Searching together: Human–AI complementarities in innovation search

Authors: Reda Hassan, Sujith Nair

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105597](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105597) **Published:** 2026-11

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Artificial Intelligence, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Search Theory, Dialectical Theory, Bounded Rationality

Abstract:

In the pursuit of innovation, diverse actors engage in frequent interactions. Although Artificial Intelligence (AI) is becoming an active participant in innovation search, less is understood about how its distinct search capabilities complement those of human actors. We explore the complementarities that emerge in human–AI search and identify three relational dialectics that arise in these interactions. The first contrasts human-centered search, which draws on internal organizational knowledge and relational networks, with AI's boundary-spanning search across distant and unfamiliar domains and its ability to synthesize dispersed internal knowledge. The second juxtaposes human contextualizing, which brings relevance and situational meaning, with AI de-contextualizing, which removes assumptions and exposes abstract, pattern-based connections. The third contrasts human judging, involving evaluation and persuasion, with AI envisaging, which generates and visualizes alternative possibilities. We argue that these dialectical complementarities bring about expanded rationality and mitigate biases in the search process, thereby enhancing the potential for innovation.

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Volume 55, Issue 8 | Published 2026-10

1. Do public credit guarantees boost R&D and innovation?

Authors: Ahmet Deryol, Leone Leonida, Gulcin Ozkan

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105560](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105560) Published: 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Policy, Entrepreneurial Finance, Public Economics
- **Theories:** Financial Constraints, Market Failure, Additionality

Abstract:

While public credit guarantees (PCGs) have been around for a long time, their use expanded significantly during the global financial crisis and the COVID-19 pandemic to support the corporate sector and facilitate economic recovery. Given the scale of these programmes and their potential fiscal implications, much of the existing literature has focused on whether PCGs improve credit allocation and financial outcomes. In contrast, this paper examines whether PCGs impact firms' R&D and innovation efforts, utilizing a rich data set from Turkey's Credit Guarantee Fund—one of the largest schemes of this kind—and employing a staggered difference-in-differences (DiD) approach preceded by a comprehensive matching procedure. We find that firms receiving guaranteed loans exhibit significantly greater improvements in both innovation inputs, such as R&D expenditure, and innovation outcomes, such as high-tech exports, compared to non-recipient firms. We also observe a substantially larger beneficial impact for firms already engaged in innovation activities and those facing financial constraints. Our findings have important implications for regulatory authorities in their design of credit support programmes.

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2. Equity crowdfunding exemptions, industrial structure, and new venture creation

Authors: Wanxiang Cai, Haneul Choi, Tianshu Zhao, Max Munday

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105578](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105578) Published: 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Finance, Regional Economics, Innovation Policy
- **Theories:** External Finance Dependence, Related Variety, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

We investigate the impact of equity crowdfunding exemptions on new venture creation. We further explore whether the effect varies across industries with different levels of external finance dependence, and whether this heterogeneity is influenced by regional industrial structures. Empirical evidence shows that, while the average effect of crowdfunding exemptions on new venture entry is not statistically significant, the impact is positive and significant in industries with higher external finance dependence. Moreover, this positive effect is further amplified in regions characterized by greater related variety. Complementary analyses show that the increase in new venture creation does not appear to be accompanied by a decline in entry quality. These findings the importance of firm-level financial constraints and regional industrial context in shaping the effectiveness of crowdfunding policies.

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3. Financing innovation: A hurdle rate theory of inventive procyclicality

Authors: David Audretsch, Wolfgang Drobetz, Eva Elena Ernst, Paul P. Momtaz, Silvio Vismara

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105565](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105565) Published: 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Economics, Corporate Finance, R&D Management
- **Theories:** Schumpeterian Theory, Hurdle Rate Theory, Real Options Theory

Abstract:

Schumpeterian arguments of "creative destruction" predict that innovation is countercyclical. However, empirical findings demonstrate the contrary. We apply corporate finance principles to innovation economics and propose a "hurdle-rate theory of inventive procyclicality." Macroeconomic episodes of high equity risk premia (ERP) stifle innovation in our sample of U.S. firms because many R&D projects do not pass corporate budgeting decisions when the aggregate discount rate is high. Consistent evidence suggests that the discount rate effect is less pronounced in firms with financial slack, weak product market competition, and institutional investor ownership with long-term orientation. In an attempt to reconcile our procyclical empirical evidence with Schumpeter's countercyclical theory, we show that firms engaging in exploratory research suffer less during high-ERP episodes than those focusing on exploitative research, and patents developed during high-ERP periods have a higher technological impact and receive significantly more forward citations. Finally, we exploit the staggered variation in state-level R&D tax credits in difference-in-differences analyses to establish a causal link between the ERP and patent value.

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4. Follow the technology or follow the leader? Radical innovation and strategic leadership at a crossroads

Authors: Sarosh Asad, Mariano L.M. Heyden, Lorenz Graf-Vlachy, Elizabeth J. Altman, Donald C. Hambrick, Zeki Simsek, Mary Tripsas

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105579](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105579) **Published:** 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Strategic Leadership Theory, Upper Echelons Theory, Ecosystem Theory, Technological Trajectories

Abstract:

Radical innovation and strategic leadership research share a foundational challenge of theorizing how firms make choices about an uncertain future that shape their competitiveness, survival, and long-term performance. Yet, each field has developed a distinct explanatory signature. Radical innovation research has followed the technology, tracing how the architecture and trajectories of technological discontinuities determine organizational fates. Strategic leadership research has followed the leader(s), tracing how the cognition, composition, and interactions of those at the organizational apex shape organizational choices. We argue that this productive division of labor is being jointly frustrated by four shifts in contemporary organizing: structurally, innovation is migrating from firms to ecosystems; technologically, AI is transforming both the creative process and the cognitive conditions of leadership; relationally, permeable boundaries are redistributing influence across actors; and culturally, evaluative criteria are expanding from performance to purpose. We identify the foundational assumptions these shifts unsettle and propose four research frontiers organized around where, how, with whom, and why radical innovation happens. We conclude with key reflections from three foundational scholars on the future of the field.

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5. How experience moderates the impact of AI suggestions on researchers' perceptions of their ideas

Authors: Matthias Tröbinger, Anil R. Doshi, Sen Chai

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105575](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105575) **Published:** 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Sociology of Science, Management of Technology, Human-Computer Interaction
- **Theories:** Human-AI Collaboration, Cognitive Evaluation Theory, Experience-Based Learning

Abstract:

At the heart of scientific discovery are researchers who identify ideas worthy of inquiry. In performing research tasks, researchers increasingly use generative artificial intelligence (AI) technologies. While this technology offers the promise of increased efficiency across the research process, little is known about how generative AI assists researchers with the generation of initial

research ideas—one of the most fundamental tasks in science—and their willingness to adopt it for such purpose. In a pre-registered randomized online experiment with 310 researchers and a follow-up ideation study with 28 researchers, we show how one's research experience plays a role in receiving generative AI suggestions when formulating new research ideas. Experience negatively moderates both the incorporation of generative AI suggestions as well as its effect on perceived novelty and impact of the researcher's idea. We also find that generative AI may be reshaping research ideation by adding a layer of non-human exchange that precedes feedback from human experts. By focusing on the critical moment at which research ideas spark, we provide an initial understanding of how researchers respond to generative AI at a time when the paradigm of human knowledge production may be shifting from a human-only to a joint human- AI model.

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6. Open user innovation, producer innovation and industrial dynamics: An ABM approach

Authors: Isabel Almudí, Francisco Fatas-Villafranca, Carlos M. Fernández-Márquez, Jason Potts, Francisco J. Vázquez, Eric von Hippel

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105573](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105573) **Published:** 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Evolutionary Economics, Industrial Dynamics, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** User Innovation Theory, Schumpeterian Dynamics, Sticky Information

Abstract:

This paper sets out to develop a unified theoretical framework integrating von Hippel user innovation and Schumpeterian industrial dynamics through a relatively simple agent-based model (ABM). The model reproduces known stylised facts, and it also generates some important theoretical results to explain the transition from community-phase to market-phase innovation, that neither paradigm addresses on its own. In our model, as user innovators develop the technology for their own use, complementary interactions with producers also begin to form. These firms seek market opportunity and require a certain minimum scale of operations before they enter. Where firms enter, they bring scale and often further innovate, which in turn, recursively feeds back into user innovation. In this way, von Hippel and Schumpeterian innovation co-evolve. Our ABM provides a formal and endogenous framework to understand these coevolutionary processes, generating theoretical results about the conditions under which it occurs. Specifically, the model simulations explore how two structural key parameters: users' attribute requirement thresholds and the degree of local sticky information, shape this co-evolutionary process. The simulations show that: (i) community fragmentation driven by high information stickiness may impede viable producer entry even when user demand exists; (ii) medium values for user attribute requirement thresholds generate a competitive advantage for pioneering firms landed at the center of the attribute space and; (iii) the industrial dynamics that emerge from user communities reproduce the Schumpeterian stylised facts, thereby providing a unifying bridge between the two paradigms. These theoretical findings have direct implications for innovation policy: (i) policy should monitor community coherence as an early signal for specific viable commercialization; (ii) a policy model that addresses information stickiness will be necessarily context-dependent and, (iii) the attribute requirement threshold suggests that producer entry strategies should be attuned to the distribution of user requirement heterogeneity.

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7. R&D accounting and innovation signaling: Insights from Japan's pre-regulation era

Authors: Kazuyuki Motohashi, Tomomi Takada, Ayung Tseng

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105549](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105549) **Published:** 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Accounting, Corporate Finance
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Information Asymmetry, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Can the way firms account for R&D shape how they innovate? We exploit Japan's pre-2000 elective R&D accounting regime—allowing firms to choose between expensing and capitalization—and its 2000 transition to mandated expensing to examine how accounting treatment shapes innovation outcomes. Using forward citations and patent applications to measure innovation quality and patenting volume across 967 Japanese firms, we find that under the elective regime, capitalized R&D is positively associated with innovation quality while expensed R&D is positively associated with patenting volume. Following the 2000 mandate, the elimination of the capitalization option leads former capitalizers to intensify patenting as a substitute disclosure mechanism, increasing applications without corresponding improvements in innovation quality. Their patenting behavior converges with always-expensing firms, reflecting an accounting-driven homogenization of innovation disclosure. These findings suggest that uniform expensing obscures economically meaningful differences in innovation activity, with implications for ongoing R&D accounting reforms at FASB and IASB.

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8. Temporary technology and the maintenance of technological sovereignty

Authors: Susanna Mansikkamäki, Antti Sihvonen, Mirva Peltoniemi, Kalle Pajunen

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105577](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105577) **Published:** 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Technology Management, Strategic Management, Economic History
- **Theories:** Technology Life Cycle, Technological Sovereignty, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

This study investigates how technologies emerge to sustain technological sovereignty in response to exogenous shocks. We focus on the efforts of the Finnish state to overcome the shortage of mineral oil-based lubricants during the Second World War and identify tar oil as a central technology in this endeavor. By analyzing the emergence and decline of the Finnish tar oil industry, we elaborate on the life cycle and key mechanisms of temporary technologies as well as their role in maintaining technological sovereignty. These findings lead to a definition of temporary technology as a distinct form of technology evolution. Our findings contribute to the technology evolution literature by theorizing a form of technology that has a limited long-term impact, making it suitable for addressing temporary shocks without altering long-term technology evolution. For the technological sovereignty literature, we extend understanding of how sovereignty can be maintained in the face of unanticipated exogenous shocks and how that involves cooperation between the state and non-state actors.

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9. When stars hold power: The impact of returnee deans on academic publications in Chinese universities

Authors: Liecheng Qiao, Xiaofang Dong

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105576](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105576) **Published:** 2026-10

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Sociology of Science, Human Capital, Higher Education Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge Spillover Theory, Social Capital Theory, Human Capital Theory

Abstract:

This study investigates the “stars effect” of recruiting overseas scholars as deans and its impact on academic output in China from 2001 to 2019. We find that appointing a returnee dean increases a department's English publications by 40% annually. This positive effect applies to both top-tier and non-top-tier journals, without crowding out Chinese publications. The magnitude of the effect correlates with the dean's international connections and the ranks of the destination and source institutions. Returnee

deans enhance output through knowledge spillovers, expanded networks, and increased overseas personnel, but not additional research grants. Our findings demonstrate the positive role and extensive influence of power-granted talent initiatives in developing regions.

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